

RDaSH Learning Hub – Volunteers

Welcome to your Volunteer learning page. We hope that you enjoy the sessions and that you find the learning beneficial to your role. The programme has been developed specifically for volunteers in health and care settings and is recognised across the NHS. This means that you can take your certifications to voluntary roles at other organisations. The modules a plain English, are accessible and do not require you to have any pre-existing level of knowledge or experience of the NHS.

Everyone who works or volunteers within the NHS is expected to undertake a level of training appropriate to their role. This is because we have a statutory duty of care to our patients, their families and carers, to our staff and to our volunteers. We require everyone to understand that they have a responsibility to keep themselves and others safe. The best way to ensure this is through training.

Training helps you to be effective in your role and gives you knowledge and skills to feel part of the team. We want you to be supported in your role and to have the confidence to develop new skills and experiences.

There are 9 modules that all volunteers at RDaSH complete. You can work through them at your own pace and you can come back to them at any time. If you require assistance completing any of them, please contact your supervisor in the first instance.

Volunteer Learning

Volunteer Learning: Standard 1 – Your role and responsibilities

Key content:

- The roles and responsibilities of being a Volunteer

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Describe your volunteer rights and responsibilities
- Explain why it is important to volunteer in ways that are agreed with your volunteer supervisor and how and when to raise any concerns you may have

- Explain why it is important to be honest and identify where errors may have occurred and to tell the appropriate person
- Describe your responsibilities to the people you support
- Describe why it is important to volunteer within a team and in partnership with others

Volunteer Learning: Standard 2 – Communication

Key content:

- Communications for Volunteers
- Data Security Awareness for Volunteers
- Conflict Resolution for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Identify good communication skills
- List some of the common, but easily avoidable, communication errors
- Identify how to improve your team playing skills through more effective communications with others
- Describe the importance of data security
- Explain how you must comply with the law
- Define potential threats to the security of information and how you can avoid or minimise them
- Identify breaches and incidents and how to avoid them
- Outline the principles of good record keeping
- List the most common causes of conflict
- Describe the different types of assault, why they occur and the most appropriate way of dealing with it
- Explain how different types of communication can affect a conflict situation
- Explain the importance of keeping a safe distance in conflict situations
- Explain the need to provide support to those directly affected by a violent incident
- Identify sources of support within your organisation

Volunteer Learning: Standard 3 – Respect for everyone

Key content:

- Equality, Diversity and Human Rights for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Explain what we mean by equality, diversity, human rights and person-centred support and why they are important
- Explain why we need to know about people's different backgrounds and why it is important not to make assumptions about individuals
- Describe what you can do to challenge prejudice and discrimination

Volunteer Learning: Standard 4 – Safeguarding

Key content:

- Safeguarding Adults for Volunteer
- Safeguarding Children for Volunteers
- Child Sexual Exploitation for Volunteers
- Preventing Radicalisation (Basic Awareness) for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Explain what the term 'adult with care and support needs' means
- Describe the process where someone is first alerted to a concern or incident that suggests an adult:
 - Is experiencing or is at risk of abuse or neglect, and
 - As a result of their care and support needs, is unable to protect themselves against abuse or neglect, or the risk of it
- Define the term 'adult safeguarding' and underlying statutory principles that underpin adult safeguarding work
- Define abuse and neglect, patterns and types and list possible indicators
- Identify why some adults are more at risk from abusive behaviour
- Explain the role you must play in recognising and reporting and who you need to speak to if you have a safeguarding concern
- Describe the different forms of child abuse (physical, emotional, sexual abuse and neglect)
- Describe how common child abuse is and the impact it can have on a child or young person
- Indicate what you should do if you do have concerns about child abuse
- Describe the risks associated with the internet and online social networking
- Describe what the term 'looked-after child'; means
- Recognise possible signs of child abuse that you might come across in your volunteering role
- Explain what child sexual exploitation (CSE) is
- Describe what you should do if you suspect that an individual is at risk or has been/is being abused
- List the objectives of the Prevent strategy
- Identify how volunteers can support Prevent
- Identify factors that can make individuals more likely to be radicalised or be a risk to others
- State what action to take if you have concerns about an individual or individuals
- Explain what makes a person vulnerable
- List how individuals may be influenced directly or indirectly
- Explain the importance of sharing information and the consequences of failing to do so

Volunteer Learning: Standard 5 – Mental Health, Dementia, Learning Disability

Key content:

- Mental Health Awareness for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Explain how common mental illness is in the general population
- Describe the breadth (or range) of mental health diagnoses and presentations
- Explain why mental health is as important as physical health
- Explain what dementia is and how it affects people
- Describe different types of learning disability
- Identify sources of support for an individual with a mental health diagnosis or learning disability
- Explain when volunteers should report concerns if they think an individual's needs are not being met
- Describe principles which volunteers can incorporate to improve interactions with individuals with mental health needs

Volunteer Learning: Standard 6 – Health and Safety

Key content:

- Health and Safety for Volunteers
- Fire Safety for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Identify ways that are consistent with legislation, policies and procedures for maintaining our own and others' health and safety
- Define the meaning of hazard, risk and risk assessment
- Recognise common hazards
- Define the characteristics of fire, smoke and toxic fumes
- Identify the main fire hazards in your volunteering environment
- Describe the actions required when discovering a fire in your volunteering environment, including how to raise alarm, what action to take when an alarm is raised, evacuation procedures and associated escape routes
- Describe basic fire safety and fire safety protocols
- Explain how to practise and promote fire prevention

Volunteer Learning: Standard 7 – Fluids and nutrition

Key content:

- Fluids and Nutrition for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Describe the importance of food safety, including hygiene, in the preparation and handling of food
- Explain the importance of good nutrition and hydration in maintaining health and well-being

- List of symptoms of poor nutrition and hydration

Volunteer Learning: Standard 8 – Basic Life Support (BLS)

Key content:

- Resuscitation (Basic Life Support) for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Recognise when someone's heart has stopped (cardiac arrest)
- Explain the best way of getting immediate help
- Describe how to do chest compressions (cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR))
- Explain what to do if an adult is choking

Volunteer Learning: Standard 9 – Moving and assisting

Key content:

- Moving and Assisting for Volunteers

By the end of this session you will be able to:

- Identify an organisation's responsibilities for promoting a safe environment including best moving and assisting practices
- Explain your responsibilities for ensuring best moving and assisting practices
- Identify risk factors that may cause injury
- Demonstrate the correct posture for safe moving and assisting practices
- Describe the importance of good back care
- Explain the importance of good communication and a team approach